

2.2 Spatial technologies: The movement of a raindrop

Go to the [Global River Runner](https://www.globalriverrunner.com/) website.

Select two different types of locations to investigate (for example, a mountain range, the centre of a continent, a coastal area, an island, or a desert region). Click on each location and observe the path a raindrop would follow from that point.

Use the table below to describe what happens at each location. Focus on where the raindrop travels, how the landscape shapes its journey, and where it eventually ends up.

	Location 1	Location 2
Describe where you started (e.g. country, region, nearby landforms, latitude and longitude)		
Describe the raindrop's journey using geographic language (e.g. north, southwest, inland, coastal, valley)		
How did topography influence the raindrops trip? (consider mountains, slopes, basins, elevation changes.)		
How did human settlements influence the raindrops trip? (e.g. dams, cities, farmland, diversions.)		
How long does the raindrop travel?		
Where does the raindrop end? Include the name of the river, lake, sea or ocean it flows into.		
Include a screenshot of the trip		

1. Which raindrop travelled the longest distance? Why do you think that is?
2. What did this activity teach you about how water moves through different environments?
3. How might the path of water affect how communities access water?

Activity 2: A raindrop hunt

Find the following and try to get as many points as possible! Include a screenshot of the trip as evidence!

Points	What to find	Screenshot
1 point	The longest raindrop trip: Find a place where the raindrop travels an extremely long distance before reaching the ocean.	
1 point	A raindrop that never reaches the ocean: Find a location where the raindrop ends in an inland basin, such as a salt lake.	
1 point	A raindrop that crosses multiple countries: Find a raindrop path that flows through two or more countries on its journey.	
1 point	A raindrop flowing north: Most rivers flow towards lower elevation. Find one that travels northward.	
2 points	A raindrop that joins a major river system: Find one that enters a well-known river (e.g. Amazon, Nile, Murray–Darling, Mississippi).	
3 points	A raindrop affected by human structures: Find an area where dams, reservoirs or diversions appear to influence the direction.	
5 points	A raindrop beginning near the coast but travelling inland first. Find a surprising example where the raindrop initially goes away from the coast due to slope.	